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Sunday Worship
8:30 & 11:00 AM

Living Savior Lutheran Church and Preschool

December 31, 2023

First Sunday after Christmas

8:30 and 11:00 AM



www.livingsaviorlutheran.org

The First Sunday after Christmas

December 31, 2023

A Service in the Spirit of

Dr. Martin Luther's German Mass and the Carols of the Season

8:30 and 11:00 A.M.

Welcome to Worship! We are still celebrating the birth of our Lord and Savior, Jesus Christ. Our liturgy this morning will be in the spirit of a liturgy developed by Dr. Martin Luther at the time of the Reformation. Luther's German Mass incorporated the hymns and chorales of that day into the German Mass. This morning we include some of those same hymns and carols into our service of worship and praise. Merry Christmas!

Prelude

The Entrance Hymn

O Come All Ye Faithful # 379



1 O come, all ye faith - ful, Joy - ful and tri - um - phant! O
4 Yea, Lord, we greet Thee, Born this hap - py morn - ing;



come ye, O come ye to Beth - le - hem;
Je - sus, to Thee be glo - ry giv'n!



Come and be - hold Him Born the king of an - gels;
Word of the Fa - ther Now in flesh ap - pear - ing!

Refrain



O come, let us a - dore Him, O come, let us a - dore Him,



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The Invocation

P In the name of the Father and of the T Son and of the Holy Spirit.

C Amen.

The Confession and Forgiveness

P If we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us.

C But if we confess our sins, God, who is faithful and just, will forgive our sins and cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

Silence for reflection on God’s Word and for self-examination.

P Let us then confess our sins to God our Father.

C Most merciful God, we confess that we are by nature sinful and unclean. We have sinned against you in thought, word, and deed, by what we have done and by what we have left undone. We have not loved you with our whole heart; we have not loved our neighbors as ourselves. We justly deserve your present and eternal punishment. For the sake of your Son, Jesus Christ, have mercy on us. Forgive us, renew us, and lead us, so that we may delight in your will and walk in your ways to the glory of your holy name. Amen.

We Are Assured of God’s Forgiveness

P In the mercy of almighty God, Jesus Christ was given to die for us, and for his sake God forgives us all our sins. To those who believe in Jesus Christ he gives the power to become the children of God and bestows on them the Holy Spirit. May the Lord, who has begun this good work in us, bring it to completion in the day of our Lord Jesus Christ.

C Amen.

The Gloria

“Angels We Have Heard on High”

#368



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The Prayer of the Day

P The Lord be with you.

C And also with you.

P Let us pray.

C Shine into our hearts the light of your wisdom, O God, and open our minds to the knowledge of your word, that in all things we may think and act according to your good will and may live continually in the light of your Son Jesus Christ, who lives and reigns with you and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

THE WORD OF GOD

The First Lesson

Isaiah 61:10-62:3

I delight greatly in the Lord; my soul rejoices in my God. For he has clothed me with garments of salvation and arrayed me in a robe of righteousness, as a bridegroom adorns his head like a priest, and as a bride adorns herself with her jewels. [11] For as the soil makes the sprout come up and a garden causes seeds to grow, so the Sovereign Lord will make righteousness and

praise spring up before all nations. [62:1] For Zion's sake I will not keep silent, for Jerusalem's sake I will not remain quiet, till her righteousness shines out like the dawn, her salvation like a blazing torch. [2] The nations will see your righteousness, and all kings your glory; you will be called by a new name that the mouth of the Lord will bestow. [3] You will be a crown of splendor in the Lord's hand, a royal diadem in the hand of your God.

- Ⓛ This is the Word of the Lord.
- Ⓒ Thanks be to God.

The Gradual Hymn **Go Tell It on the Mountain # 388**

Refrain

Go tell it on the moun - tain, O-ver the hills and ev - 'ry - where;

Go tell it on the moun - tain That Je - sus Christ is born!

1 While shep-herds kept their watch-ing O'er si - lent flocks by night,

Refrain
Be - hold, through - out the heav-ens There shone a ho - ly light.

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The Second Lesson **Galatians 4:4-7**

But when the time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under law, [5] to redeem those under law, that we might receive the full rights of sons. [6] Because you are sons, God sent the Spirit of his Son into our hearts, the Spirit who calls out, "Abba, Father." [7] So you are no longer a slave, but a son; and since you are a son, God has made you also an heir.

- Ⓛ This is the Word of the Lord.
- Ⓒ Thanks be to God.

Verse **"From Heaven Above to Earth I Come" # 358**

1 "From heav'n a - bove to earth I come To bear good

news to ev - 'ry home; Glad tid - ings of great

joy I bring, Where - of I now will say and sing:

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The Holy Gospel **Luke 2:22-40**

- Ⓟ The Holy Gospel according to St. Luke, the 2nd chapter.
- Ⓒ Glory to you, O Lord.

When the time came for the purification rites required by the Law of Moses, Joseph and Mary took him to Jerusalem to present him to the Lord [23] (as it is written in the Law of the Lord, "Every firstborn male is to be consecrated to the Lord"[a]), [24] and to offer a sacrifice in keeping with what is said in the Law of the Lord: "a pair of doves or two young pigeons." [25] Now there was a man in Jerusalem called Simeon, who was righteous and devout. He was waiting for the consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit was on him. [26] It had been revealed to him by the Holy Spirit that he would not die before he had seen the Lord's Messiah. [27] Moved by the Spirit, he went into the temple courts. When the parents brought in the child Jesus to do for him what the custom of the Law required, [28] Simeon took him in his arms and praised God, saying: [29] "Sovereign Lord, as you have promised, you may now dismiss your servant in peace. [30] For my eyes have seen your salvation, [31] which you have prepared in the sight of all nations: [32] a light for revelation to the Gentiles, and the glory of your people Israel." [33] The child's father and mother marveled at what was said about him. [34] Then Simeon blessed them and said to Mary, his mother: "This child is destined to cause the falling and rising of many in Israel, and

to be a sign that will be spoken against, [35] so that the thoughts of many hearts will be revealed. And a sword will pierce your own soul too.” [36] There was also a prophet, Anna, the daughter of Penuel, of the tribe of Asher. She was very old; she had lived with her husband seven years after her marriage, [37] and then was a widow until she was eighty-four. She never left the temple but worshiped night and day, fasting and praying. [38] Coming up to them at that very moment, she gave thanks to God and spoke about the child to all who were looking forward to the redemption of Jerusalem. [39] When Joseph and Mary had done everything required by the Law of the Lord, they returned to Galilee to their own town of Nazareth. [40] And the child grew and became strong; he was filled with wisdom, and the grace of God was on him.

P This is the Gospel of the Lord.
C Praise to you, O Christ.

Hymn of the Day Let All Together Praise Our God # 389



1 Let all to - geth - er praise our God Be - fore His
4 He un - der - takes a great ex - change, Puts on our



glo - rious throne; To - day He o - pens heav'n a - gain To
hu - man frame, And in re - turn gives us His realm, His



give us His own Son, To give us His own Son.
glo - ry, and His name, His glo - ry, and His name.

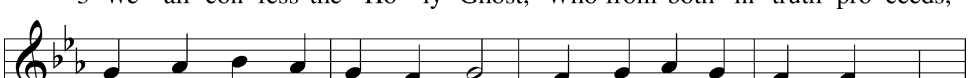
7 Your grace in lowliness revealed,
Lord Jesus, we adore
And praise to God the Father yield
And Spirit evermore;
We praise You evermore.

The Sermon Vicar Stephen Wareham

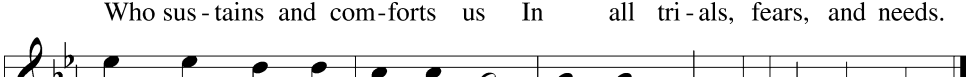
Creed “We All Believe in One True God” # 953



1 We all be - lieve in one true God, Fa - ther, Son, and Ho - ly Ghost,
2 We all be - lieve in Je - sus Christ, Son of God and Mar - y's son,
3 We all con - fess the Ho - ly Ghost, Who from both in truth pro - ceeds,



Ev - er - pres - ent help in need, Praised by all the heav'n - ly host;
Who de - scend - ed from His throne And for us sal - va - tion won;
Who sus - tains and com - forts us In all tri - als, fears, and needs.



All He made His love en - folds, All cre - a - tion He up - holds.
By whose cross and death are we Res - cued from all mis - er - y.
Bless - ed, ho - ly Trin - i - ty, Praise for - ev - er be to Thee!

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Offering Music

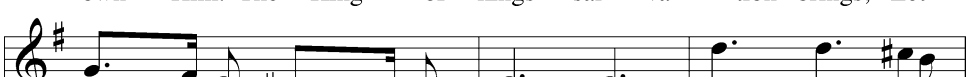
Congregational Offertory “What Child Is This” # 370



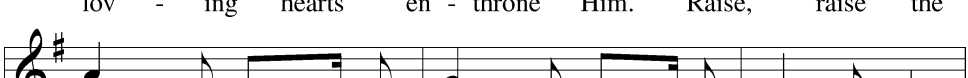
3 So bring Him in - cense, gold, and myrrh; Come, peas - ant, king, to



own Him. The King of kings sal - va - tion brings; Let



lov - ing hearts en - throne Him. Raise, raise the



song on high, The vir - gin sings her lul - la - by;



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The Prayers of the People of God

P Let us pray for the whole people of God in Christ Jesus, and for all people according to their needs. Almighty God, with the joy of the incarnation of your Son in our hearts, we pray that you would so govern your Church and bless all ministers and people that they may be steadfast in the true doctrine of Christ both here and throughout the world, that all may come to know the Christ who came to share our humanity that we might become partakers of his divine nature. Lord, in your mercy,

C **hear our prayer.**

P Look graciously on our nation. Protect its liberties and advance the daily and eternal welfare of all. Preserve those who serve in public office that, under their leadership, we may lead quiet and peaceful lives in all godliness and honesty. Lord, in your mercy,

C **hear our prayer.**

P As you entrusted your Son to the care of Mary and Joseph, look in mercy on all our families. Grant that they may be safe havens where children are nurtured in love. Bless the education and instruction of our youth that they may grow up in living faith to praise your name. Lord, in your mercy,

C **hear our prayer.**

P In your love provide for all who are sick, grieving, or lonely [especially. . .]. Remember in mercy all who are being tried with temptation and those who suffer for your name's sake. Comfort them with your favor and healing, and deliver them according to your good pleasure. Lord, in your mercy,

C **hear our prayer.**

P Into your hands, O Lord, we commend all for whom we pray, trusting in your mercy, through your son, Jesus Christ, our Lord.

C **Amen.**

The Lord's Prayer

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us, and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever and ever. Amen.

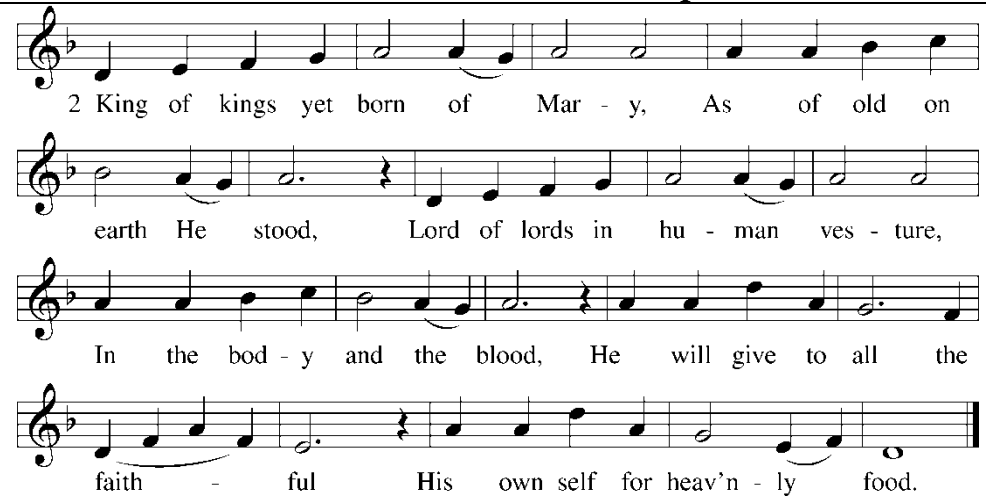
✠ The Words of Institution

P The peace of the Lord be with you always.

C **And also with you.**

THE SANCTUS Let All Mortal Flesh Keep Silence

621



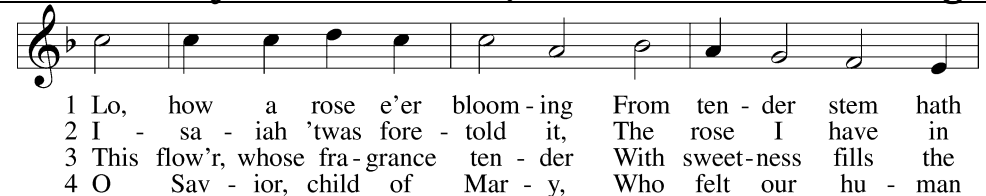
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The Distribution

Communion Hymn

“Lo, How a Rose E'er Blooming”

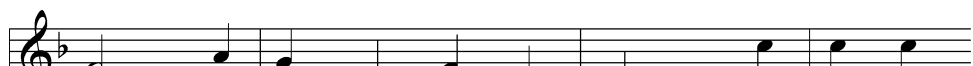
359



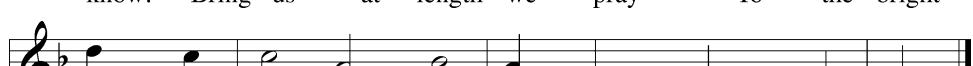
1 Lo, how a rose e'er bloom-ing From ten-der stem hath
2 I - sa - iah 'twas fore - told it, The rose I have in
3 This flow'r, whose fra-grance ten-der With sweet-ness fills the
4 O Sav - ior, child of Mar - y, Who felt our hu - man



sprung! Of Jes - se's lin - eage com - ing As proph-ets long have
mind; With Mar - y we be - hold it, The vir - gin moth - er
air, Dis - pels with glo - rious splen - dor The dark-ness ev - 'ry -
woe; O Sav - ior, King of glo - ry, Who dost our weak - ness



sung, It came, a flow - 'ret bright, A - mid the
kind. To show God's love a - right, She bore to
where. True man, yet ver - y God, From sin and
know: Bring us at length we pray To the bright



cold of win - ter, When half - spent was the night.
us a Sav - ior, When half - spent was the night.
death He saves us And light - ens ev - 'ry load.
courts of heav - en, And to the end - less day.

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Prayer of Thanksgiving

P O God the Father, the fountain and source of all goodness, who in loving-kindness sent your only begotten Son into the flesh, we thank you that for his sake you have given us pardon and peace in this sacrament, and we ask you not to forsake your children but always to rule our hearts and minds by your Holy Spirit that we may be enabled to serve you constantly; through Jesus Christ, your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with you and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C Amen.

The Benediction

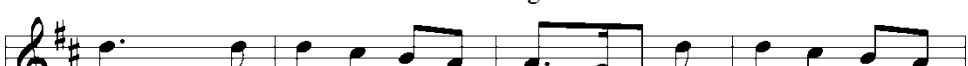
P The Lord bless you and keep you.
The Lord make his face shine on you and be gracious to you.
The Lord look upon you with favor and give you peace.

C Amen.

The Closing Hymn Joy to the World # 387



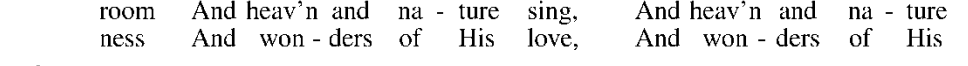
1 Joy to the world, the Lord is come! Let earth re - ceive her
4 He rules the world with truth and grace And makes the na - tions



King; Let ev - 'ry heart pre - pare Him
prove The glo - ries of His righ - teous -



room And heav'n and na - ture sing, And heav'n and na - ture
ness And won - ders of His love, And won - ders of His



sing, And heav'n, and heav'n and na - ture sing.
love, And won - ders, won - ders of His love.

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Announcements

Postlude